

HELDER MENDES - CV

Frontend / Full Stack development ▪ Graphic Design Background

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Portfolio: helderdesign.nl ▪ GitHub: github.com/HelderMendes



PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Frontend Developer with full-stack experience – specializing in React and Next.js. I combine strong design skills with modern UI/UX delivery – from legacy migrations to polished, performant interfaces. Open-source contributor (OpenML/TU Eindhoven). 15+ years of experience across the entire product lifecycle, including former Art Director with a Graphic Design degree.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Frontend: React, Next.js (App Router, SSR, SSG, API Routes), TypeScript, Tailwind CSS, shadcn/ui, Flowbite
State, Data & Validation: Zustand, TanStack Query, TanStack Router, Zod.

Backend & APIs: Python (FastAPI, Pydantic), REST APIs.

Databases & ORM: Prisma, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Mongoose, Firebase, Neon.

Authentication & Tools: Clerk, Auth.js, Lucia, OAuth, Stripe, Resend, Cloudinary, UploadThing

Infra & DevOps: Docker Compose, Kubernetes, CI/CD, Vercel, Netlify, Git, GitHub, Linux CLI

Testing: React Testing Library (RTL) and E2E Testing with Playwright

Design: Adobe XD, Photoshop, Illustrator, Figma, Canva | Visual hierarchy, typography, UI consistency

AI & Automation: GitHub Copilot, Gemini, Claude, Inngest, MCP (Model Context Protocol)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

- **FULL-STACK DEVELOPER (OPEN SOURCE MIGRATION)**
 - openML.org (TU/Eindhoven) | 6-Month Engagement
 - openmlorg.vercel.app (preProduction)

Frontend Migration Lead: Orchestrated the high-scale migration of the OpenML.org platform to a modern Next.js architecture, improving performance and SEO for the global machine learning community.

Containerization & Orchestration: Developed Docker images and Compose configs for multi-service architecture (Frontend, API, Database, Elasticsearch).

Microservices Deployment: Managed the multi-deployment lifecycle within a Kubernetes (K8s) environment, ensuring scalability.

Workflow: GitHub PRs and CI/CD pipelines for open-source contributions.

Backend Integration: Collaborated on Python microservices, aligning FastAPI endpoints with Next.js frontend.

Design Systems: Applied a Graphic Design background to build accessible UI for complex scientific data.

SELECTED TECHNICAL PROJECTS

Lookout Mode – Next.js + Tailwind CSS – Full-featured fashion e-commerce store prototype with a responsive design. (lookoutmode.vercel.app)

Phone Case Customizer – Next.js + UploadThing – Interactive e-commerce prototype with image upload and customization. (phone-case-sepia.vercel.app)

Tharros Training & Coaching – React – Modern, company website. (tharros-trainingcoaching.nl).

Additional projects: Ticketing system, Movie DB app, SaaS dashboards – see GitHub & portfolio.

faect-nl.vercel.app ▪ multi-ai-chat-sand.vercel.app ▪ helbug-social.vercel.app

lux-segment.netlify.app ▪ emlinked.nl ▪ faect.nl

■ DESIGN & WEB DEVELOPMENT ■

● FREELANCE WEB DEVELOPER & DESIGNER – 2010 - PRESENT

- Developed and maintained 30+ WordPress websites and webshops, including multisite setups, migrations, security hardening, updates, and custom features (dynamic pricing, custom checkout, variable shipping, ticketing, donations, memberships, events with UserPro integration, and cookie consent).
- Provided ongoing technical support, hosting management, and client assistance.
- Key clients and projects: biomaatschappij.nl, werkenhetskpoel.nl, stichtingdeboshalte.nl, museumhogewoerd.nl, fastfit-automotivesoftware.com, emlinked.nl, faect.nl and many others in coaching, culture, and business sectors..

● WEB DESIGNER & DEVELOPER – 2010 - PRESENT

- Developed and maintained 30+ WordPress sites and webshops (multisite, migrations, security, custom features: dynamic pricing, custom checkout, ticketing, memberships).
- Clients include: studiobassa.nl, fastfit-automotivesoftware.com, emlinked.nl, biomaatschappijenl, and 25+ others in coaching, culture, and business.
- Designed and built SME websites across coaching, fashion, ICT, and culture – focusing on clean design, SEO, and HTTPS.

● FREELANCE GRAPHIC DESIGNER – 2006 - 2018

- Created magazines, logos, brand identities, books, brochures, annual reports for clients in education, human rights, culture, and business (Nyenrode Now, Hersenstichting Nederland, Nauta Dutilh).

● GRAPHIC DESIGNER/ART DIRECTOR (EMPLOYMENT) – 1993 - 2005

- [Studio de Geallieerden, Amsterdam](#) (2005–2009) – Broedplaats for journalists/designers
- [Hemels International Publishers, Hilversum](#) (2000–2004) – Corporate magazines for DaimlerChrysler, Mercedes, Philips, Lanschot Bankiers – Art Director
- [Comm'part Reclame, Apeldoorn](#) (1999–2000) – Promotional materials, brochures, ads
- [Edições Arrábida, Lisbon](#) (1995–1999) – Art Director, editorial design

■ STUDIES ■

[Next.JS](#) – with Brad Traversy 2022

[The Complete Web Development Bootcamp](#) – London App Brewery 2022

[Full Stack Web Development: HTML, CSS, React & Node](#) – web development with HTML, CSS, Bootstrap 4, ES6 React and Node 2021/2022

[MERN Stack Front To Back Full Stack React, Redux & Node.js](#) – Udemy 2021

[Escola Superior de Belas-Artes de Lisboa](#) – Design Gráfico Sep.88 - Jun.93

■ LANGUAGE ■

Dutch	Fluent (speaking/understanding), sufficient (writing) – NT2 level
English	Fluent (speaking/understanding), sufficient (writing)
Portuguese	Native
Spanish	Good (speaking/understanding), moderate (writing)